

A PERSONAL KNOWLEDGE SYSTEM

Siddhesh Thapa

A record of what I think, what I
build, what I believe, and what I
eventually realize I was wrong
about.

SIDDHESHTHAPA.COM · V0.3 — COGNITIVE GEOGRAPHY

TWELVE REGIONS · 72 OBJECTS · 73 EXPLAINED RELATIONSHIPS · 12 AUGUST 2026

CAPTURED FROM THE WORKING PROTOTYPE AT 1440 × 900

A PERSONAL KNOWLEDGE SYSTEM

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ENTER THE MIND →

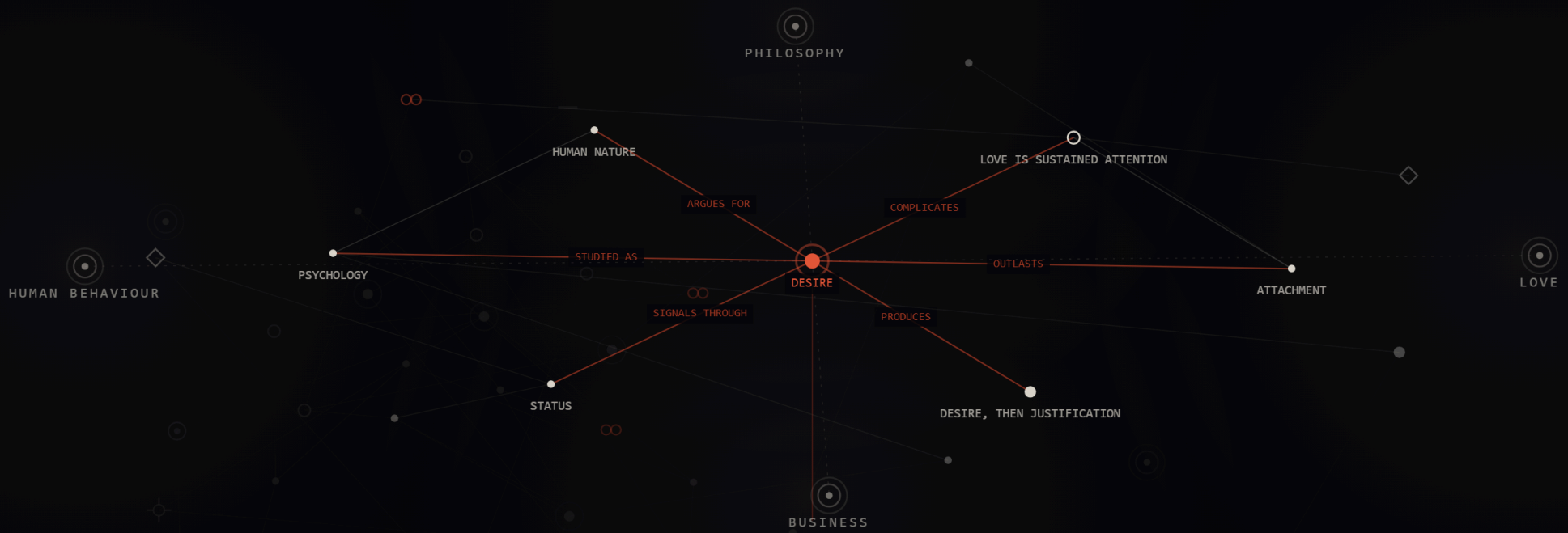
Plate 01

The threshold

Unchanged since V0.1, and deliberately. No navigation, no menu, no claim about who he is. The map is already running behind the gradient — regions drift, a relationship occasionally activates on its own, and fragments of thought surface and fade. The single link reads as a question rather than a button.







CONCEPT • FORMED

desire

The engine underneath most behaviour I used to explain with better-sounding words.

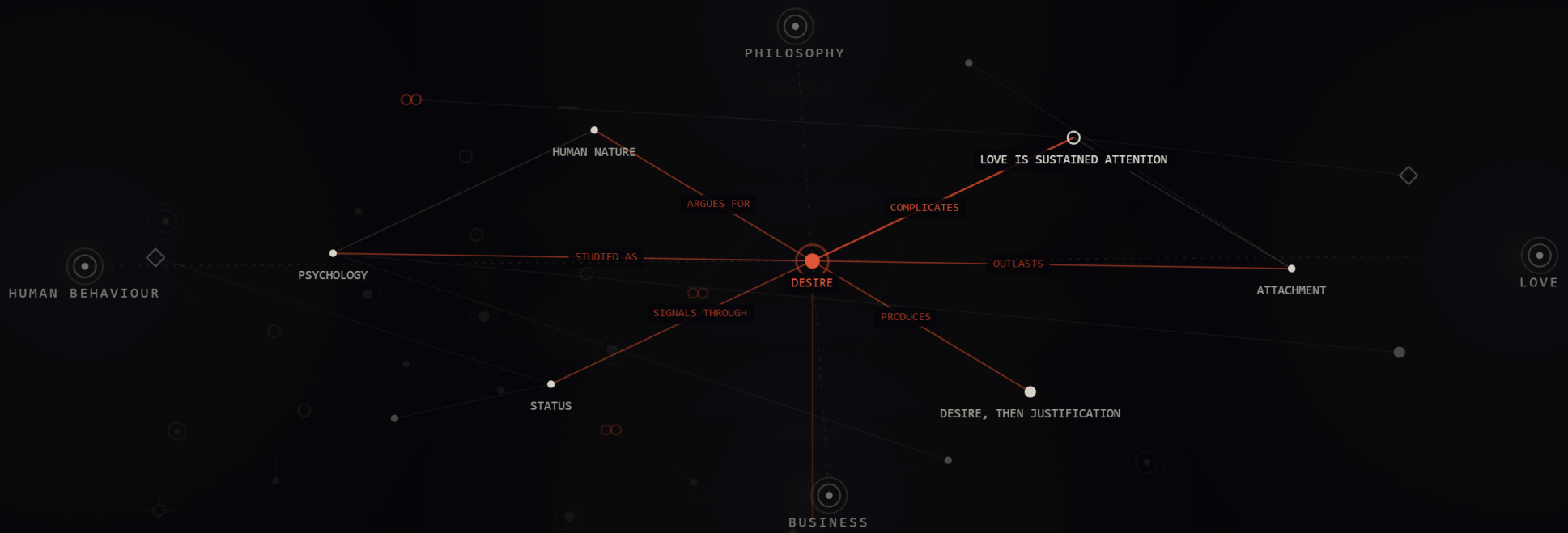
6 connections. Move over one to see why it is there.

SITS IN • HUMAN BEHAVIOUR • PHILOSOPHY • LOVE • BUSINESS

SEE WHERE IT STARTED → SEE WHAT IT BECAME →

SEE WHAT CONTRADICTS IT → WANDER FROM HERE →

THE WHOLE MAP



CONCEPT • FORMED

desire

The engine underneath most behaviour I used to explain with better-sounding words.

DESIRE • COMPLICATES • LOVE IS SUSTAINED ATTENTION

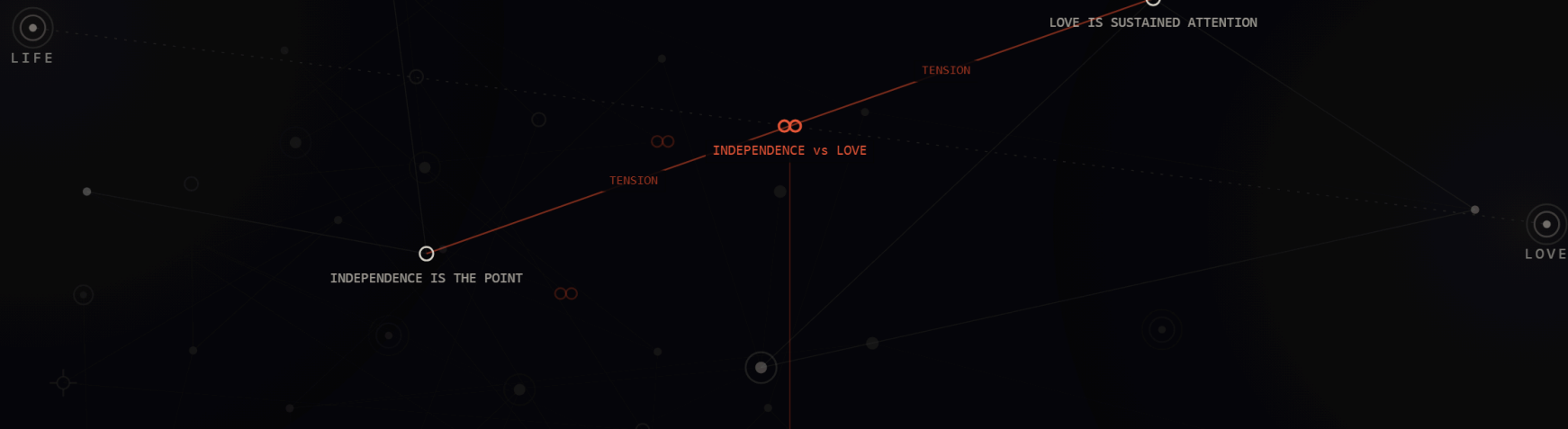
"I do not think desire and love are as cleanly separable as we pretend."

SITS IN • HUMAN BEHAVIOUR • PHILOSOPHY • LOVE • BUSINESS

SEE WHERE IT STARTED → SEE WHAT IT BECAME →

SEE WHAT CONTRADICTS IT → WANDER FROM HERE →

THE WHOLE MAP



CONTRADICTION • OPEN

independence vs love

I want to need no one, and I want to be known.
These are not the same project.

2 connections. Move over one to see why it is there.

SITS IN • LIFE • LOVE

SEE WHAT IT BECAME →

WANDER FROM HERE →

THE WHOLE MAP

Plate 07

Tension across a border

Contradictions are objects in the graph, and the interesting ones span regions. Independence sits in Life and Business; sustained attention sits in Love. Holding both is not a coherent position, and the site says so rather than choosing: *"I want to need no one, and I want to be known. These are not the same project."*

Geography without folders.

The hardest constraint in the brief: organize the mind without implying the mind is organized by subject. Three mechanisms carry it, and none of them is a container.

MEMBERSHIP IS DECLARED BY THE MEMBER

A region holds no list. The index is derived at load by scanning what each node claims. A region cannot gain or lose members on its own, and no node has a single parent.

57 of 60 non-region nodes name more than one region, so belonging in several places is the normal case, not the exception.

POSITION IS THE ARGUMENT

Home is the weighted centroid of the regions that claim a node, first region weighted heaviest. A concept naming four regions physically lands between them.

Polymathy is therefore never asserted anywhere in the copy. It is where things are standing.

TERRITORY IS DRAWN, BORDERS ARE NOT

Each region paints a radial field whose radius comes from how far its own members actually scattered. Fields overlap freely and have no edge.

There is no box, outline or fill boundary anywhere in the system. A border would be the exact claim the site exists to deny.

Level is a consequence, not a control.

The V0.2 failure was a beautiful field of points a visitor could not orient inside. Level follows from what is selected, so nobody has to operate a zoom they were never told about — and each level has a hard label budget.

LEVEL	TRIGGER	WHAT CARRIES A LABEL	LAYOUT
world	entry, or “the whole map”	12 region labels, nothing else	every node at its map home; leaves are faint territory
region	a region is selected	region · ≤9 members · 11 rim regions	region centred, members on the inner ellipse, other regions on the rim
concept	a concept or thought is selected	focus · its relations · its home regions	focus centred, relations on the inner ellipse, home regions on the rim
content	the same selection	—	the writing emerges inside the environment; no page change, no sidebar

THE RIM IS THE ANTI-TREE

At every focused level the other regions stay on screen, placed by their real bearing from the map. From inside Music you can see Philosophy in the direction Philosophy actually lies and go there in one click, without stepping back up a hierarchy. That is what stops orientation hardening into navigation.

WANDER IS ASSOCIATIVE

Two or three hops. Candidates are a node's relations plus its regions plus, for a region, its members. Steps that cross into an unshared region are preferred at 0.62. Dice-rolling produces arrivals a visitor cannot account for — the failure the whole level model is fighting. Every arrival is recorded in a clickable trail.

Seventy-three connections, each one arguable.

Every edge carries a direction, a semantic verb and a first-person explanation. None exists because two things are adjacent or both interesting. A sample of what a visitor uncovers crossing regions:

A SONG STORES A PERSON **STORES** MEMORY

"A song does not store the memory. It stores who you were while it was playing."

RITUAL **SHOWS UP AS** THE ARGUMENT DISH

"Every family has one dish that is really an unfinished argument about who they are."

MONEY **POORLY PROXIES** VALUE

"I think money is a poor proxy for value. It is just the only one that clears."

DISCIPLINE **BUYS** FREEDOM

"Discipline is what freedom costs, which is an annoying thing to be true."

MEMORY **ASSEMBLES** IDENTITY

"I am mostly a set of things I remember badly and remember consistently."

DESIRE **COMPLICATES** LOVE IS SUSTAINED ATTENTION

"I do not think desire and love are as cleanly separable as we pretend."

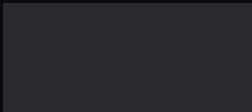
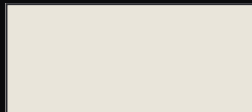
AI **CHANGED THE ECONOMICS OF** TEACHING

"AI moved individualised instruction from prohibitively expensive to nearly free. That changes who gets to learn what."

MORTALITY **FORCES** MEANING

"Meaning is what you reach for once you have accepted the deadline."

The palette and the type were the approved part.

 OBSIDIAN #0B0B0D	 VOID #08080A · the field	 HAIRLINE #2A2A30	 WARM IVORY #E9E5DA	 OXIDIZED RED #C4432B · signature	 OXIDE DIM #6E2618
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REGIONS ARE DELIBERATELY NOT COLOUR-CODED

Twelve hues would be instantly legible, and would rebuild precisely the subject taxonomy the site argues against. Regions are told apart by position, label and field density instead.

Red stays semantic: selection, the active relationship, contradiction rings, relationship verbs (dimmed so the selected path stays brightest), and the rule beside emerging content. That is the complete list.

ONE PERFORMANCE DECISION WORTH RECORDING

Twelve large radial fields per frame is genuinely expensive under software rasterization — it hung headless Chrome outright, a fair proxy for a visitor on weak hardware.

Fields now render once into an offscreen layer and are blitted per frame, refreshed only when the world reorganizes. They drift two or three pixels; the staleness is invisible and the per-frame cost is a single draw.

Thirty criteria, checked by machine.

Two validators parse the arrays straight out of the page rather than trusting a read-through. They caught a real gap: the brief's own chain philosophy → desire → psychology → marketing → business was broken by a missing edge.

01-03	Orientation.	Twelve labelled regions over faint territory; nothing else named until approached.
04-07	Hierarchy.	world → region → concept → content, each gating its own label budget.
08-10	Polymathy.	57 of 60 nodes cross regions; no subjects menu exists anywhere.
11-14	Relationships.	All 73 carry direction, verb and gloss; no pair exists in both directions.
open	Content is placeholder	in his voice, written as arguable positions rather than filler. Every line is his to correct.

15-19	Exploration.	Region and concept focus both reorganize the world; trail and rim answer "how did I get here".
20-22	Human depth.	Life, Music, Movies, Food and Love are ordinary regions, each opening onto six or more others.
23-26	Visual consistency.	One palette, three type roles, red semantic, no gradients-as-decoration or rounded cards.
27-30	Production cleanliness.	The design record left the site; it lives in a separate handbook.
open	Observation and Technology are thin	— four and five members. Enough to prove the system, first to fill.